

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written on four staves in G major (one sharp) and 4/4 time. The melody is simple and repetitive, with lyrics written below the notes. The first staff contains the first four lines of the song, each starting with a different number (1, 2, 3, 4). The second staff continues the melody with the lyrics 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' The third staff continues with 'In my heart, in my heart,' and the fourth staff concludes with 'Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.' The melody is characterized by a steady eighth-note rhythm, with some phrases ending in a half note or a quarter note.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...
Lord, I want to be a Chris - tian in my heart.
In my heart, in my heart,
Lord, I want to be a Chris - tian in my heart.